

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 4

New Case: Aryan – Problem-Solving & Cognitive Work

Full Detailed – More Realistic Style

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	Aryan (32 y/o Male)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	4 of 18–20	Focus:	Problem-solving + Cognitive restructuring

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client practiced Worry Time on most days with mixed results — some days it helped contain worry, other days the worries felt too strong to postpone. He attempted the time-limit experiment again with partial success. He expressed frustration that progress feels slow. Today's plan: Review homework, introduce **structured problem-solving**, continue cognitive restructuring, and assign integrated homework.

SESSION START & HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, Aryan. How has your week been? Let's review the homework.

Client: It was okay. Worry Time helped on some days, but on other days the worries felt too strong and I couldn't postpone them. I tried the time-limit thing again and managed to stop after 45 minutes once. But I still feel like I'm not improving fast enough.

Therapist: Thank you for sharing that honestly. It's very normal for new techniques to work on some days and not on others in the beginning. The fact that you managed to stop after 45 minutes on one occasion is progress. These skills usually become stronger with practice.

INTRODUCING STRUCTURED PROBLEM-SOLVING

Therapist: Many people with anxiety also benefit from learning structured problem-solving. When we're anxious, our thinking can become very black-and-white, which makes solving problems harder. Would you like to learn a simple step-by-step method?

Client: I guess... I often feel stuck when there's a work problem.

Therapist: The steps are:

1. Define the problem clearly and specifically
2. Brainstorm as many solutions as possible (even silly ones)
3. Evaluate the pros and cons of each solution
4. Choose the best solution(s) and make a plan
5. Carry out the plan and review how it went

Therapist: Let's practice with one current work problem you're facing.

(They work through a current issue: difficulty saying no to extra tasks from the team lead. They brainstorm solutions together and choose one small step to try.)

CONTINUING COGNITIVE RESTRUCTURING

Therapist: Last session your belief in the thought "I have to be perfect or they will start doubting me" was around 65%. How much do you believe it now?

Client: It's still around 60%. It hasn't changed much this week.

Therapist: That's okay. Change is often gradual. Let's look at the evidence you collected for and against the thought this week.

Client: I wrote some points... but I still feel like the old thought is stronger.

Therapist: That's completely normal at this stage. The balanced thought usually becomes stronger slowly as we keep collecting real-life evidence through experiments and daily experiences. We don't need to force it.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue daily diary + Worry Time practice
2. Use the problem-solving steps on at least one work issue this week
3. Continue rating belief in the old thought and using the balanced thought
4. Try the time-limit experiment again with a small task

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your mixed experience with Worry Time, introduced structured problem-solving, and continued working on your key thought. How are you feeling about today's session?

Client: The problem-solving steps were useful. I still feel like change is slow though.

Therapist: That's a very common feeling. These skills take time to become natural. Any questions?

Client: No.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client had mixed results with Worry Time — realistic.
- Introduced structured problem-solving; client responded positively.
- Belief in old thought remains stable around 60% — normal at this stage.
- Client expressed frustration about slow progress — realistic.
- Next session: Review problem-solving attempts, continue cognitive work, introduce behavioral activation elements if energy/motivation is low.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.